

And that's when I realized he wasn't just listening to this stuff; he was *writing* it.

I signaled for him to turn the volume down and take off his headphones. He obliged.

"Hey, Dad," he said, business as usual. "What's up?"

I could have started in on him about how his racket was giving the entire household a headache, but something in me knew to hold off. "Will you explain to me what you're doing?"

"Sure. Have a seat," Trevor said.

Over the next half-hour, my son walked me through some incredible software and taught me a little about the very complex authoring systems on his computer—the kind producers use to record bands.

"Want to listen?" he asked. He slipped his headphones over my ears. Once the volume was set at a rational level, I was absolutely astonished by what I heard. Trevor had laid down tracks on the piano and then modified them, downloading voices from the Internet, as well as sound bites he recorded himself. After a few minutes of listening to his composition, I could tell he had some genuine talent. I can't take any credit—my son surpassed me on the guitar years ago. He can pick up any instrument, from piano to trombone, and he just gets it. Linda's father has won all sorts of awards for choral arrangements, so Trevor must have gotten his musical genius from his mother's side.

It didn't take me long to conclude that Trevor had gotten very advanced with this electronic stuff. He was tuned in to the DJ culture around the world, and that's the sort of music he was creating—music young people could dance to.

"I have a track called 'Orangutan,' " Trevor told me. "I've sampled orangutan screams from the jungle and made them into a music track for clubs."

"Really?"

"Yeah. Would you tweet it for me?"

Oh no, I was thinking. My son wants me to use my hard-earned fan base and tweet monkey noises to them. "You want me to do what?"